

Session Resume & Persistence

Introduced: v1.0.0 (February 2025) | Latest enhancements: v2.1.53

What It Is

Session resume lets you pick up Claude Code conversations exactly where you left off. Every session is automatically saved to disk – including full message history, tool results, and checkpoints. You can continue the most recent session, browse and resume any past session, or fork a session to explore alternative approaches without losing the original.

Why It Matters

Long coding tasks rarely finish in one sitting. Session resume means you can: – Start a feature at work, continue at home – Explore a risky approach, then fork back to safety if it fails – Resume PR-linked sessions when reviewers leave feedback – Keep 50+ named sessions organized across projects

Quick Start (60 Seconds)

Start a session, work on something, then exit

```
claude
> implement oauth2 flow
> exit
```

Continue where you left off

```
claude -c
```

Browse all sessions interactively

```
claude -r
```

Resume a specific named session

```
claude -r "oauth-work"
```

All CLI Flags

Flag	Short	Description
<code>--continue</code>	<code>-c</code>	Continue most recent session in current directory

Flag	Short	Description
<code>--resume [name]</code>	<code>-r</code>	Interactive picker, or resume by name/ID
<code>--fork-session</code>	<code>-</code>	Create new session ID while preserving history
<code>--from-pr [number]</code>	<code>-</code>	Resume session linked to a GitHub PR
<code>--session-id <uuid></code>	<code>-</code>	Use a specific session UUID
<code>--no-session-persistence</code>		Disable saving (only with <code>-p</code> print mode)

Configuration

Sessions are stored automatically. No configuration needed.

Storage location:

`~/.claude/projects/<directory-hash>/<session-id>/`

Disable persistence (scripting only):

`claude -p --no-session-persistence "one-off query"`

Real-World Workflows

Workflow 1: Multi-Day Feature Development

Day 1: Start the feature

```
claude
> implement user authentication with JWT
> [work for 2 hours]
> /rename jwt-auth
```

Day 2: Pick up where you left off

```
claude -r jwt-auth
> now add refresh token rotation
> [continue for 1 hour]
```

Day 3: Resume again

```
claude -c # continues jwt-auth (most recent)
```

Workflow 2: Fork to Try an Alternative

Working on approach A

```
claude -r jwt-auth  
> [halfway through implementation]
```

Want to try approach B without losing A

```
claude -c --fork-session  
> actually, let's try passport.js instead  
> [explore for 30 minutes, decide it's worse]  
> exit
```

Original session A is untouched

```
claude -r jwt-auth  
> [continue with original approach]
```

Workflow 3: Resume from PR Feedback

Create PR with Claude

```
claude  
> fix the race condition in session handler  
> [Claude commits and creates PR]
```

Later, reviewer leaves feedback

```
claude --from-pr 142  
> address the reviewer's comments about error handling
```

Session Picker Navigation

When you run `claude -r` (interactive picker):

Key	Action
Up/Down	Navigate sessions
Enter	Resume selected
P	Preview session content
R	Rename session
/	Search/filter
A	Toggle: current directory vs all projects
B	Filter to current git branch
Esc	Exit

The picker shows up to **50 sessions** (expanded from 10 in v2.1.47).

How It Interacts With Other Features

Feature	Interaction
Worktrees	Each worktree has separate session history. <code>-r</code> in worktree shows only worktree sessions
Agent Teams	In-process teammates are NOT preserved on resume. Must respawn
Checkpoints	Preserved per session. <code>Esc Esc</code> rewinds within the resumed session
CLAUDE.md	Reloaded on each resume – changes take effect immediately
Auto Memory	Memory is global, survives resume and fork
Remote Control	Can <code>/rc</code> a resumed session to continue from another device
tmux	<code>tmux attach + claude -c</code> = resume from SSH

Gotchas & Tips

1. **Don't resume the same session in two terminals** – messages interleave and corrupt history. Use `--fork-session` instead.
2. **Sessions are directory-scoped** – you can't resume a session from `/project-a/` while in `/project-b/`. Use `claude -r` with `A` to see all projects.
3. **Permission modes reset on resume** – if you used `--permission-mode` originally, set it again or configure in `settings.json`.
4. **Context compaction** – large sessions may compress history. Put persistent instructions in `CLAUDE.md`, not in conversation.
5. **Name your sessions** – `/rename` `auth-refactor` makes them easy to find later. Unnamed sessions show the first prompt as the title.
6. **Fork creates a separate session** – the fork and original are both listed in the picker. Clean up forks you don't need.

Version History

Version	Date	Change
<code>v1.0.0</code>	Feb 2025	Basic <code>-c</code> and <code>-r</code> session continue/resume

Version	Date	Change
v2.0.0	Sept 2025	Checkpoint system integrated with sessions
v2.1.0	Jan 2026	/teleport to move sessions to web
v2.1.41	Jan 2026	/rename command, session naming
v2.1.47	Feb 2026	Picker expanded to 50 sessions, title persistence after resume, large message support
v2.1.49	Feb 2026	--fork-session and --from-pr flags
v2.1.51	Feb 2026	Remote Control integration with sessions